

WHY WE CROSS OURSELVES & WHAT IT MEANS

SESSION 00.2 HANDOUT

NAME _____ DATE _____

♦ MEMORY VERSE — COPY BY HAND

The Apostle Paul wrote this to the Christians in Galatia. It is the deepest reason an Orthodox Christian crosses himself many times a day. Copy the verse below twice in your best handwriting.

God forbid that I should glory, save in the Cross of our Lord Jesus Christ. — Galatians 6:14

♦ VOCABULARY — MATCH EACH WORD TO ITS MEANING

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

SIGN OF THE CROSS	•	• The two natures of Christ — fully God and fully man — shown by tucking these two fingers down into the palm.
TRINITY	•	• A small prayer made with the right hand, tracing the shape of the Cross on your own body — forehead, chest, right shoulder, left shoulder.
THREE FINGERS	•	• The Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit — three Persons, one God — confessed by pressing these three fingertips together.
TWO FINGERS	•	• Greek for <i>bowing down</i> — the honor we give the Cross, an icon, or a saint, which is different from worship.

♦ SEQUENCE — NUMBER THE FOUR TOUCHES

The Sign of the Cross is four touches in a specific order. Number them from **1** to **4** in the boxes below.

- ☐ Right shoulder — *He is at the right hand of the Father.*
- ☐ Forehead — *Jesus came down from heaven.*
- ☐ Left shoulder — *He gathers the lost and brings them home.*
- ☐ Chest — *He came down to the earth and to us.*

♦ SKETCH — DRAW YOUR RIGHT HAND HELD IN THE SIGN OF THE CROSS

Draw your own right hand in the box below, in the position you use for the Sign of the Cross.

- Press the **thumb, pointer finger, and middle finger** together at the tips. Label them: "**Holy Trinity — three Persons, one God**"
- Tuck the **ring finger and pinky** down into your palm. Label them: "**Two natures of Christ — fully God, fully man**"

[draw your right hand here]

◆ REFLECTION — WRITE 3 TO 5 SENTENCES

The lesson said: *your body prays too*. In the Christianity you grew up with, prayer was mostly something you did with your mind and your voice. Now you are learning that the whole person prays — body and soul together. Write 3 to 5 sentences about what it has felt like this week to pray with your hand. Where did you cross yourself? When? Did anything feel different from praying only with your voice? *It's okay if it felt strange. It's okay to write that.*